

ADVANCED TOPICS ON ALGORITHMS

Search & Sorting

Author: Eng. Carlos Andrés Sierra, M.Sc.
cavirguezs@udistrital.edu.co

Full-time Adjunct Professor
Computer Engineering Program
School of Engineering
Universidad Distrital Francisco José de Caldas

2026-I



Course Outline

1 Search Algorithms

2 Sorting Algorithms



Outline

1 Search Algorithms

2 Sorting Algorithms



Linear Search Algorithm and Analysis

Definition

Linear search is a sequential algorithm that checks each element in a data structure until the target element is found or all elements have been examined.

1: **Algorithm** LINEARSEARCH(A, x)

2: // Input: Array $A[1..n]$, search value x

3: // Output: Index of x in A , or -1 if not found

4: **for** $i = 1$ **to** $\text{length}(A)$ **do**

5: **if** $A[i] = x$ **then**

6: **return** i

7: **end if**

8: **end for**

9: **return** -1 // Element not found

return index

not found

$x \Rightarrow$ index

Python
None $\rightarrow$ not found



Linear Search Algorithm and Analysis

Definition

Linear search is a **sequential** algorithm that checks each element in a data structure until the target element is found or all elements have been examined.

```

1: Algorithm LINEARSEARCH( $A, x$ )
2: // Input: Array  $A[1..n]$ , search value  $x$ 
3: // Output: Index of  $x$  in  $A$ , or -1 if not found
4: for  $i = 1$  to  $\text{length}(A)$  do
5:   if  $A[i] = x$  then
6:     return  $i$ 
7:   end if
8: end for
9: return -1 // Element not found
  
```

Handwritten notes: "all indexes" (next to line 4), "Concrete" (next to line 9), "0, item A", "1, item B", "..." (next to line 9).



Sequential Access Principles

Characteristics:

- **Order Independence:** Works on unsorted data
- **Memory Efficiency:** Constant space complexity $O(1)$
- **Simple Implementation:** Easy to understand and code
- **No Preprocessing:** Can search immediately

Advantages

- Works on any data structure
- No sorting requirement
- Simple to implement
- Guaranteed to find element (if exists)

Disadvantages

- Slow for large datasets
- Cannot skip elements
- Time increases linearly with size
- No early termination optimization



Sequential Access Principles

Characteristics:

- **Order Independence:** Works on unsorted data
- **Memory Efficiency:** Constant space complexity $O(1)$
- **Simple Implementation:** Easy to understand and code
- **No Preprocessing:** Can search immediately

Advantages

- Works on any data structure
- No sorting requirement
- Simple to implement
- Guaranteed to find element (if exists)

Disadvantages

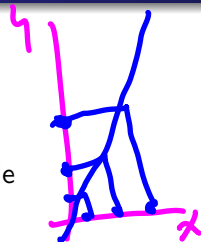
- Slow for large datasets
- Cannot skip elements
- Time increases linearly with size
- No early termination optimization



Sequential Access Principles

Characteristics:

- **Order Independence:** Works on unsorted data
- **Memory Efficiency:** Constant space complexity $O(1)$
- **Simple Implementation:** Easy to understand and code
- **No Preprocessing:** Can search immediately



Advantages

- Works on any data structure
- No sorting requirement
- Simple to implement
- Guaranteed to find element (if exists)

Disadvantages

- Slow for large datasets
- Cannot skip elements
- Time increases linearly with size
- No early termination optimization



Study Case: Searching in Phone Directory

Problem

Find a person's phone number in a phone directory containing 1000 entries.

Example

Linear Search Approach:

```
Algorithm FINDPHONENUMBER(directory, name)  
for  $i = 1$  to  $\text{length}(\text{directory})$  do  
    if  $\text{directory}[i].\text{name} = \text{name}$  then  
        return  $\text{directory}[i].\text{phone}$   
    end if  
end for  
return "Not Found"
```



Study Case: Searching in Phone Directory

Problem

Find a person's phone number in a phone directory containing 1000 entries.

Example

Linear Search Approach:

```
Algorithm FINDPHONENUMBER(directory, name)  
for  $i = 1$  to  $\text{length}(\text{directory})$  do  
    if  $\text{directory}[i].\text{name} = \text{name}$  then  
        return  $\text{directory}[i].\text{phone}$   
    end if  
end for  
return "Not Found"
```



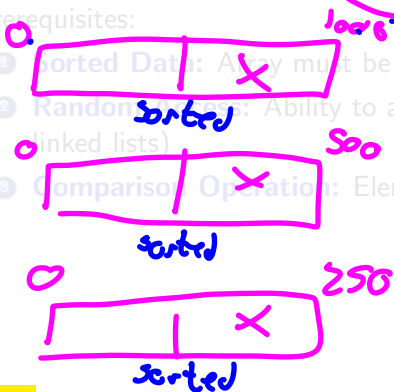
Binary Search Algorithm and Requirements

Definition

Binary search is a **divide-and-conquer** algorithm that finds an element in a **sorted** array by repeatedly dividing the search **interval** in half.

Prerequisites:

1. **Sorted Data:** Array must be sorted in ascending or descending order
2. **Random Access:** Ability to access any element directly (arrays, not linked lists)
3. **Comparison Operation:** Elements must be comparable



change value,
not the
structure



Binary Search Algorithm and Requirements

Definition

Binary search is a **divide-and-conquer** algorithm that finds an element in a sorted array by repeatedly dividing the search **interval in half**.

Prerequisites:

- ① **Sorted Data:** Array must be sorted in ascending or descending order
- ② **Random Access:** Ability to access any element directly (arrays, not linked lists)
- ③ **Comparison Operation:** Elements must be comparable

sorted

$\left[\frac{7}{2} \right]$



Binary Search Algorithm

```

1: Algorithm BINARYSEARCH( $A, x, low, high$ )
2: while  $low \leq high$  do
3:    $mid \leftarrow \lfloor \frac{low+high}{2} \rfloor$ 
4:   if  $A[mid] = x$  then
5:     return  $mid$ 
6:   else if  $A[mid] < x$  then
7:      $low \leftarrow mid + 1$ 
8:   else .
9:      $high \leftarrow mid - 1$ 
10:  end if
11: end while
12: return  $-1$ 

```

²¹⁰
Q low high mid

1000	○	999	499
499	○	498	249
249	○	248	124
124	123	248	182
65	183	248	
.			
.			
.			

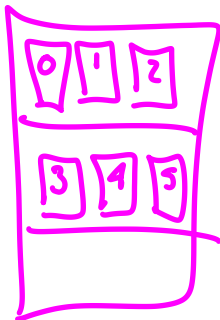


Study Case: Library Book Location System

Problem

Locate a book in a library catalog system with 100,000 books organized by ISBN

code



isbn → order
name
section
closet
level



Study Case: Library Book Location System

Example

Algorithm `FINDBOOK(catalog, target_isbn)`

low $\leftarrow$ 1

high $\leftarrow$ *length*(*catalog*) - 1

while *low* $\leq$ *high* **do**

mid $\leftarrow$ $\lfloor \frac{low+high}{2} \rfloor$

if *catalog*[*mid*].*isbn* = *target_isbn* **then**

return *catalog*[*mid*] // Return book information

else if *catalog*[*mid*].*isbn* < *target_isbn* **then**

low $\leftarrow$ *mid* + 1

else

high $\leftarrow$ *mid* - 1

end if

end while

return "Book not found"

ISBN sorted



Interpolation Search Introduction

Definition

Interpolation search improves upon binary search by making educated guesses about where the target element might be located, based on the values at the endpoints.

Key Concept

Instead of always choosing the middle element, interpolation search estimates the position using:

$$pos = low + \frac{(x - A[low])}{(A[high] - A[low])} \times (high - low)$$



Interpolation Search Introduction

Definition

Interpolation search improves upon binary search by making educated **guesses** about where the target element might be located, based on the values at the endpoints.

Key Concept

Instead of always choosing the middle element, interpolation search estimates the position using:

$$\text{pos} = \text{low} + \frac{(x - A[\text{low}])}{(A[\text{high}] - A[\text{low}])} \times (\text{high} - \text{low})$$

mid

low
10

x

pos

pos

high
20

$$18 - 10 = 8 \div 10 = 0.8$$

$$18 - 10 = 8 \div 10 = 0.8$$



Interpolation Search Algorithm

```

1: Algorithm INTERPOLATIONSEARCH( $A, x, low, high$ )
2: while  $low \leq high$  and  $x \geq A[low]$  and  $x \leq A[high]$  do
3:    $pos \leftarrow low + \frac{(x - A[low])}{(A[high] - A[low])} \times (high - low)$ 
4:   if  $A[pos] = x$  then
5:     return  $pos$ 
6:   else if  $A[pos] < x$  then
7:      $low \leftarrow pos + 1$ 
8:   else
9:      $high \leftarrow pos - 1$ 
10:  end if
11: end while
12: return  $-1$ 

```

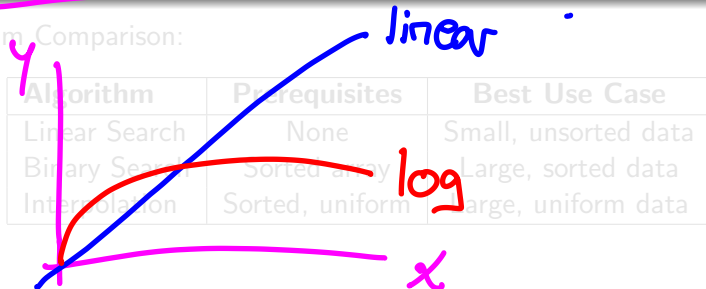


Search Algorithm Selection Criteria

Decision Framework

- **Data Size:** How many elements to search?
- **Data Organization:** Is the data sorted?
- **Search Frequency:** One-time or repeated searches?
- **Data Distribution:** Uniformly distributed values?
- **Memory Constraints:** Available space for preprocessing?

Algorithm Comparison:



Search Algorithm Selection Criteria

Decision Framework

- **Data Size:** How many elements to search?
- **Data Organization:** Is the data sorted?
- **Search Frequency:** One-time or repeated searches?
- **Data Distribution:** Uniformly distributed values?
- **Memory Constraints:** Available space for preprocessing?

Algorithm Comparison:

Algorithm	Prerequisites	Best Use Case
Linear Search	None	Small, unsorted data
Binary Search	Sorted array	Large, sorted data
Interpolation	Sorted, uniform	Large, uniform data



Study Case: Guess the Number (Large Space)

Problem

Guess a secret number between 1 and 1,000,000 with minimum guesses.

	x_1	x_2	x_3	x_4
Linear	if?	if?	if?	if?
Binary	if?	if?	if?	if?
Interpolation	if?	if?	if?	if?



Outline

1 Search Algorithms

2 Sorting Algorithms

Universal $\Rightarrow$ D & C

$\hookrightarrow \sim \text{linear} \rightarrow$ for
for



Bubble Sort Algorithm and Mechanism

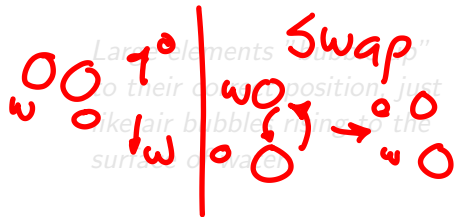
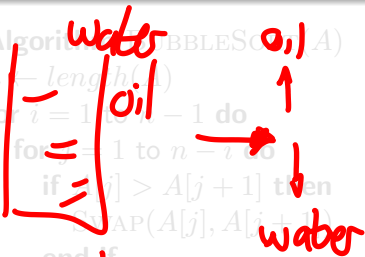
Definition

Bubble sort is a simple sorting algorithm that repeatedly steps through the list, compares adjacent elements, and swaps them if they are in the wrong order.

```

1: Algorithm BUBBLESORT(A)
2:   n ← length(A)
3:   for i = 1 to n - 1 do
4:     for j = 1 to n - i do
5:       if A[j] > A[j + 1] then
6:         SWAP(A[j], A[j + 1])
7:       end if
8:     end for
9:   end for

```



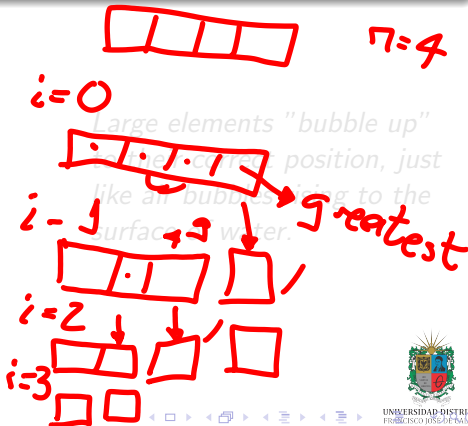
Bubble Sort Algorithm and Mechanism

Definition

Bubble sort is a simple sorting algorithm that **repeatedly** steps through the list, compares adjacent elements, and swaps them if they are in the wrong order.

```

1: Algorithm BUBBLESORT( $A$ )
2:  $n \leftarrow \text{length}(A)$ 
3: for  $i = 1$  to  $n - 1$  do
4:   for  $j = 1$  to  $n - i$  do
5:     if  $A[j] > A[j + 1]$  then
6:       SWAP( $A[j], A[j + 1]$ )
7:     end if
8:   end for
9: end for
  
```



Bubble Sort Algorithm and Mechanism

Definition

Bubble sort is a simple sorting algorithm that **repeatedly** steps through the list, compares adjacent elements, and swaps them if they are in the wrong order.

```

1: Algorithm BUBBLESORT( $A$ )
2:  $n \leftarrow \text{length}(A)$ 
3: for  $i = 1$  to  $n - 1$  do
4:   for  $j = 1$  to  $n - i$  do
5:     if  $A[j] > A[j + 1]$  then
6:       SWAP( $A[j], A[j + 1]$ )
7:     end if
8:   end for
9: end for
  
```

Large elements "bubble up" to their correct position, just like air bubbles rising to the surface of water.

Handwritten notes illustrating the mechanism:

$7^2 / 4^{16}$ 5^{25} 10000^{100000}



Adjacent Element Comparison Approach

Core Mechanism

Bubble sort works by making multiple passes through the array, comparing each pair of adjacent elements and swapping them if they're out of order.

Example

Step-by-step example: Sort [64, 34, 25, 12, 22, 11, 90]

Pass 1:

- Compare 64, 34 → Swap → [34, 64, 25, 12, 22, 11, 90]
- Compare 64, 25 → Swap → [34, 25, 64, 12, 22, 11, 90]
- Compare 64, 12 → Swap → [34, 25, 12, 64, 22, 11, 90]
- Compare 64, 22 → Swap → [34, 25, 12, 22, 64, 11, 90]
- Compare 64, 11 → Swap → [34, 25, 12, 22, 11, 64, 90]
- Compare 64, 90 → No swap → [34, 25, 12, 22, 11, 64, 90]

After Pass 1: Largest element (90) is in correct position!

Adjacent Element Comparison Approach

Core Mechanism

Bubble sort works by making **multiple passes** through the array, comparing each pair of **adjacent elements** and swapping them if they're out of order.

Example

Step-by-step example: Sort [64, 34, 25, 12, 22, 11, 90]

Pass 1:

- Compare 64, 34 → Swap → [34, 64, 25, 12, 22, 11, 90]
- Compare 64, 25 → Swap → [34, 25, 64, 12, 22, 11, 90]
- Compare 64, 12 → Swap → [34, 25, 12, 64, 22, 11, 90]
- Compare 64, 22 → Swap → [34, 25, 12, 22, 64, 11, 90]
- Compare 64, 11 → Swap → [34, 25, 12, 22, 11, 64, 90]
- Compare 64, 90 → No swap → [34, 25, 12, 22, 11, 64, 90]

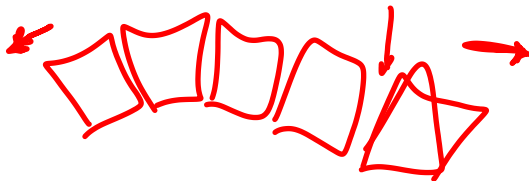
After Pass 1: Largest element (90) is in correct position!

90 is best

Study Case: Sorting Playing Cards

Real-World Application

You have a hand of playing cards and want to sort them by value. How would you naturally do this?



Selection Sort Algorithm and Approach

Definition

Selection sort sorts by repeatedly finding the **minimum element** from the **unsorted portion** and placing it at the beginning.

Key Characteristics:

- **Invariant:** After i iterations, first i elements are sorted
- **Selections:** Makes exactly $n - 1$ swaps
- **Comparisons:** Always $\frac{n(n-1)}{2}$ comparisons



Selection Sort Algorithm and Approach

Definition

Selection sort sorts by repeatedly finding the **minimum element** from the unsorted portion and placing it at the beginning.

Key Characteristics:

- **Invariant:** After i iterations, first i elements are sorted
- **Selections:** Makes exactly $n - 1$ swaps
- **Comparisons:** Always $\frac{n(n-1)}{2}$ comparisons

$$\frac{7(7-1)}{2}$$

→ bubble
↓
last i
sorted

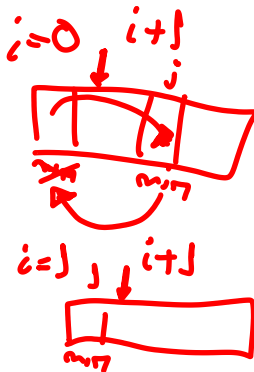


Selection Sort Algorithm

```

1: Algorithm SELECTIONSORT( $A$ )
2:  $n \leftarrow \text{length}(A)$   $0 \rightarrow n-2$ 
3: for  $i = 1$  to  $n - 1$  do
4:    $\text{min\_index} \leftarrow i$ 
5:   for  $j = i + 1$  to  $n$  do
6:     if  $A[j] < A[\text{min\_index}]$  then
7:        $\text{min\_index} \leftarrow j$ 
8:     end if
9:   end for
10:  SWAP( $A[i], A[\text{min\_index}]$ )
11: end for

```



Minimum/Maximum Selection Strategy

Core Strategy

Selection sort maintains two regions:

- **Sorted region:** Elements already in final position
- **Unsorted region:** Elements yet to be processed

Example

Sorting [64, 25, 12, 22, 11]:

Pass	Array State	Action
Initial	[64, 25, 12, 22, 11]	Find min in [64,25,12,22,11]
1	[11, 25, 12, 22, 64]	Min=11, swap with 64
2	[11, 12, 25, 22, 64]	Min=12, swap with 25
3	[11, 12, 22, 25, 64]	Min=22, swap with 25
4	[11, 12, 22, 25, 64]	Min=25, no swap needed



Minimum/Maximum Selection Strategy

Core Strategy

Selection sort maintains two regions:

- **Sorted region:** Elements already in final position
- **Unsorted region:** Elements yet to be processed

Example

Sorting [64, 25, 12, 22, 11]:

Pass	Array State	Action
Initial	[64, 25, 12, 22, 11]	Find min in [64,25,12,22,11]
1	[11, 25, 12, 22, 64]	Min=11, swap with 64
2	[11, 12, 25, 22, 64]	Min=12, swap with 25
3	[11, 12, 22, 25, 64]	Min=22, swap with 25
4	[11, 12, 22, 25, 64]	Min=25, no swap needed



Study Case: Student Grades Enrollment Schedule

Problem

A professor needs to organize student grades for enrollment priority. Students with higher GPAs get priority registration.

Example

Student Records:

Student Name	GPA
Alice	3.8
Bob	2.5
Charlie	3.9
Diana	2.1
Eve	3.7



Study Case: Student Grades Enrollment Schedule [Solution]

```
1: Algorithm ORGANIZEBYGPA(students)
2: for  $i = 1$  to  $\text{length}(\text{students}) - 1$  do
3:    $\text{max\_gpa\_index} \leftarrow i$ 
4:   for  $j = i + 1$  to  $\text{length}(\text{students})$  do
5:     if  $\text{students}[j].\text{gpa} > \text{students}[\text{max\_gpa\_index}].\text{gpa}$  then
6:        $\text{max\_gpa\_index} \leftarrow j$ 
7:     end if
8:   end for
9:   SWAP( $\text{students}[i]$ ,  $\text{students}[\text{max\_gpa\_index}]$ )
10: end for
```

Result: Priority Order

Charlie (3.9) $\rightarrow$ Alice (3.8) $\rightarrow$ Eve (3.7) $\rightarrow$ Bob (2.5) $\rightarrow$ Diana (2.1)



Study Case: Student Grades Enrollment Schedule [Solution]

```
1: Algorithm ORGANIZEBYGPA(students)
2: for  $i = 1$  to  $\text{length}(\text{students}) - 1$  do
3:    $\text{max\_gpa\_index} \leftarrow i$ 
4:   for  $j = i + 1$  to  $\text{length}(\text{students})$  do
5:     if  $\text{students}[j].\text{gpa} > \text{students}[\text{max\_gpa\_index}].\text{gpa}$  then
6:        $\text{max\_gpa\_index} \leftarrow j$ 
7:     end if
8:   end for
9:   SWAP( $\text{students}[i]$ ,  $\text{students}[\text{max\_gpa\_index}]$ )
10: end for
```

Result: Priority Order

Charlie (3.9) $\rightarrow$ Alice (3.8) $\rightarrow$ Eve (3.7) $\rightarrow$ Bob (2.5) $\rightarrow$ Diana (2.1)



Insertion Sort Algorithm and Methodology

Definition

Insertion sort builds the final sorted array one element at a time by repeatedly taking an element from the unsorted portion and **inserting** it into its correct position in the sorted portion.

```

1: Algorithm INSERTIONSORT(A)
2: for  $i = 2$  to  $\text{length}(A)$  do
3:    $key \leftarrow A[i]$ 
4:    $j \leftarrow i - 1$ 
5:   while  $j \geq 1$  and  $A[j] > key$  do
6:      $A[j + 1] \leftarrow A[j]$ 
7:      $j \leftarrow j - 1$ 
8:   end while
9:    $A[j + 1] \leftarrow key$ 
10: end for
  
```



Insertion Sort Algorithm and Methodology

Definition

Insertion sort builds the final sorted array one element at a time by repeatedly taking an element from the unsorted portion and **inserting** it into its correct position in the sorted portion.

```
1: Algorithm INSERTIONSORT( $A$ )
2: for  $i = 2$  to  $length(A)$  do
3:    $key \leftarrow A[i]$ 
4:    $j \leftarrow i - 1$ 
5:   while  $j \geq 1$  and  $A[j] > key$  do
6:      $A[j + 1] \leftarrow A[j]$ 
7:      $j \leftarrow j - 1$ 
8:   end while
9:    $A[j + 1] \leftarrow key$ 
10: end for
```



Incremental Sorting Approach I

Insertion sort works like organizing playing cards in your hand:

- 1 Start with first card (trivially sorted)
- 2 Pick next card from unsorted pile
- 3 Find correct position in sorted portion
- 4 Shift other cards as needed
- 5 Insert card in correct position
- 6 Repeat until all cards are sorted



Incremental Sorting Approach I

Example

Sorting [5, 2, 4, 6, 1, 3]:

Step	Array State	Action
Initial	[5, 2, 4, 6, 1, 3]	Start with first element
1	[2, 5, 4, 6, 1, 3]	Insert 2 before 5
2	[2, 4, 5, 6, 1, 3]	Insert 4 between 2 and 5
3	[2, 4, 5, 6, 1, 3]	6 already in position
4	[1, 2, 4, 5, 6, 3]	Insert 1 at beginning
5	[1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6]	Insert 3 between 2 and 4



Study Case: Alphabetical Name Sorting

Problem

Sort a class roster alphabetically for easy lookup during attendance.

Example

Class Roster: [David, Alice, Charlie, Bob, Eve]

Insertion Sort Process:

Step	Roster State
Initial	[David, Alice, Charlie, Bob, Eve]
1	[Alice, David, Charlie, Bob, Eve]
2	[Alice, Charlie, David, Bob, Eve]
3	[Alice, Bob, Charlie, David, Eve]
4	[Alice, Bob, Charlie, David, Eve]



Study Case: Alphabetical Name Sorting

Problem

Sort a class roster alphabetically for easy lookup during attendance.

Example

Class Roster: [David, Alice, Charlie, Bob, Eve]

Insertion Sort Process:

Step	Roster State
Initial	[David, Alice, Charlie, Bob, Eve]
1	[Alice, David, Charlie, Bob, Eve]
2	[Alice, Charlie, David, Bob, Eve]
3	[Alice, Bob, Charlie, David, Eve]
4	[Alice, Bob, Charlie, David, Eve]



Study Case: UD Students Code Sorting (Sort Battle)

Programming Challenge!

Universidad Distrital students are identified by codes like "20192578001". Sort student codes efficiently for registration processing.

Challenge Rules

- Input: 1000 student codes in random order
- Goal: Sort in ascending order
- Competition: Which algorithm performs best?
- Test different algorithms with same dataset

Example

Sample Student Codes: [20192578001, 20202589123, 20171098765]

Sorted Result: [20171098765, 20192578001, 20202589123]



Study Case: UD Students Code Sorting (Sort Battle)

Programming Challenge!

Universidad Distrital students are identified by codes like "20192578001". Sort student codes efficiently for registration processing.

Challenge Rules

- Input: 1000 student codes in random order
- Goal: Sort in ascending order
- Competition: Which algorithm performs best?
- Test different algorithms with same dataset

Example

Sample Student Codes: [20192578001, 20202589123, 20171098765]

Sorted Result: [20171098765, 20192578001, 20202589123]



Quick Sort Algorithm (Divide & Conquer Application) I

Definition

Quick sort is a divide-and-conquer algorithm that sorts by selecting a **pivot** element and partitioning the array around it, then recursively sorting the subarrays.

```
1: Algorithm QUICKSORT( $A, low, high$ )  
2: if  $low < high$  then  
3:    $pivot\_index \leftarrow \text{PARTITION}(A, low, high)$   
4:   QUICKSORT( $A, low, pivot\_index - 1$ )  
5:   QUICKSORT( $A, pivot\_index + 1, high$ )  
6: end if
```



Quick Sort Algorithm (Divide & Conquer Application) II

```
1: Algorithm PARTITION( $A, low, high$ )
2:  $pivot \leftarrow A[high]$  // Choose last element as pivot
3:  $i \leftarrow low - 1$  // Index of smaller element
4: for  $j = low$  to  $high - 1$  do
5:   if  $A[j] \leq pivot$  then
6:      $i \leftarrow i + 1$ 
7:     SWAP( $A[i], A[j]$ )
8:   end if
9: end for
10: SWAP( $A[i + 1], A[high]$ )
11: return  $i + 1$ 
```



Partition Strategy and Pivot Selection

Partitioning Process

The partition operation rearranges the array so that:

- Elements smaller than pivot are on the left
- Elements greater than pivot are on the right
- Pivot is in its final sorted position

Pivot Selection Strategies:

- 1 **First Element:** Simple but poor for sorted data
- 2 **Last Element:** Common choice, same issue
- 3 **Random Element:** Good average performance
- 4 **Median-of-Three:** Choose median of first, middle, last
- 5 **True Median:** Best but expensive to compute



Partition Strategy and Pivot Selection

Partitioning Process

The partition operation rearranges the array so that:

- Elements smaller than pivot are on the left
- Elements greater than pivot are on the right
- Pivot is in its final sorted position

Pivot Selection Strategies:

- 1 **First Element:** Simple but poor for sorted data
- 2 **Last Element:** Common choice, same issue
- 3 **Random Element:** Good average performance
- 4 **Median-of-Three:** Choose median of first, middle, last
- 5 **True Median:** Best but expensive to compute



Study Case: UD Students Code Sorting (The Final Challenge)

Ultimate Sorting Challenge!

Now we face the final boss: Sort 100,000 UD student codes using Quick Sort. Can it handle the massive dataset?

Challenge Specifications

- **Dataset Size:** 100,000 student codes
- **Format:** 11-digit codes (e.g., 20192578001)
- **Goal:** Sort in under 1 second
- **Memory Limit:** In-place sorting preferred



Study Case: UD Students Code Sorting (The Final Challenge)

Ultimate Sorting Challenge!

Now we face the final boss: Sort 100,000 UD student codes using Quick Sort. Can it handle the massive dataset?

Challenge Specifications

- **Dataset Size:** 100,000 student codes
- **Format:** 11-digit codes (e.g., 20192578001)
- **Goal:** Sort in under 1 second
- **Memory Limit:** In-place sorting preferred



Merge Sort Algorithm (Divide & Conquer Application) I

Definition

Merge sort is a stable, divide-and-conquer algorithm that divides the array into **halves**, recursively **sorts** them, and then **merges the sorted** halves.

```
1: Algorithm MERGESORT( $A, left, right$ )  
2: if  $left < right$  then  
3:    $mid \leftarrow \lfloor \frac{left+right}{2} \rfloor$   
4:   MERGESORT( $A, left, mid$ )  
5:   MERGESORT( $A, mid + 1, right$ )  
6:   MERGE( $A, left, mid, right$ )  
7: end if
```



Merge Sort Algorithm (Divide & Conquer Application) I

Definition

Merge sort is a stable, divide-and-conquer algorithm that divides the array into **halves**, recursively **sorts** them, and then **merges the sorted** halves.

- 1: **Algorithm** MERGESORT($A, left, right$)
- 2: **if** $left < right$ **then**
- 3: $mid \leftarrow \lfloor \frac{left+right}{2} \rfloor$
- 4: MERGESORT($A, left, mid$)
- 5: MERGESORT($A, mid + 1, right$)
- 6: MERGE($A, left, mid, right$)
- 7: **end if**



Merge Sort Algorithm (Divide & Conquer Application) II

- 1: **Algorithm** MERGE($A, left, mid, right$)
- 2: Create temporary arrays $L[left..mid]$ and $R[mid + 1..right]$
- 3: Copy data to temporary arrays
- 4: $i \leftarrow 0, j \leftarrow 0, k \leftarrow left$
- 5: **while** $i < len(L)$ **and** $j < len(R)$ **do**
- 6: **if** $L[i] \leq R[j]$ **then**
- 7: $A[k] \leftarrow L[i]; i \leftarrow i + 1$
- 8: **else**
- 9: $A[k] \leftarrow R[j]; j \leftarrow j + 1$
- 10: **end if**
- 11: $k \leftarrow k + 1$
- 12: **end while**
- 13: Copy remaining elements of L and R to A



Merge Strategy and Stability

Merge Strategy

The merge operation combines two sorted subarrays into one sorted array:

- 1 Compare the first elements of both subarrays
- 2 Select the smaller element and add to result
- 3 Move pointer in that subarray
- 4 Repeat until one subarray is exhausted
- 5 Copy remaining elements from other subarray

Stability Property

Merge sort is **stable** because when elements are equal, we always take from the left array first, preserving the original relative order.



Merge Strategy and Stability

Merge Strategy

The merge operation combines two sorted subarrays into one sorted array:

- 1 Compare the first elements of both subarrays
- 2 Select the smaller element and add to result
- 3 Move pointer in that subarray
- 4 Repeat until one subarray is exhausted
- 5 Copy remaining elements from other subarray

Stability Property

Merge sort is **stable** because when elements are equal, we always take from the left array first, preserving the original relative order.



Study Case: Real-time Sorting

Problem

A live streaming platform needs to sort viewer comments by timestamp in real-time while new comments continuously arrive.

Example

Scenario: Comments arrive every millisecond during a popular stream

Requirements:

- Sort existing comments while new ones arrive
- Maintain chronological order (stability important)
- Handle high volume (100,000+ comments/minute)
- Provide sorted output for display



When to Use Which Sorting Algorithm

Decision Matrix

Algorithm	Time Complexity	Stable	Best Use Case
Bubble Sort	$O(n^2)$	Yes	Educational/tiny datasets
Selection Sort	$O(n^2)$	No	Minimizing swaps
Insertion Sort	$O(n^2)$	Yes	Nearly sorted data
Quick Sort	$O(n \log n)$	No	General purpose
Merge Sort	$O(n \log n)$	Yes	Stability required

Choose Based on Requirements:

- **Stability needed:** Merge sort or Insertion sort
- **Memory limited:** Quick sort or Insertion sort
- **Partially sorted:** Insertion sort
- **Random data:** Quick sort
- **Guaranteed performance:** Merge sort



Performance Trade-offs Analysis

Comprehensive Performance Comparison

Let's analyze the trade-offs between different sorting algorithms across multiple dimensions.

Key Insights

- **Simplicity vs. Efficiency:** $O(n^2)$ algorithms are simpler but slower
- **Memory vs. Speed:** Faster algorithms often use more memory
- **Stability Cost:** Stable algorithms may be slightly slower
- **Adaptive Algorithms:** Some perform better on partially sorted data



Summary: Advanced Sorting & Searching I

Search Algorithms Summary

- **Linear Search:** Simple, works on any data, $O(n)$ time
- **Binary Search:** Efficient for sorted data, $O(\log n)$ time
- **Interpolation Search:** Best for uniform data, $O(\log \log n)$ average

Sorting Algorithms Summary

- **Simple Sorts ($O(n^2)$):** Bubble, Selection, Insertion - good for small data
- **Advanced Sorts ($O(n \log n)$):** Quick Sort (fast), Merge Sort (stable)
- **Algorithm Choice:** Depends on data size, memory, stability requirements



Summary: Advanced Sorting & Searching I

Search Algorithms Summary

- **Linear Search:** Simple, works on any data, $O(n)$ time
- **Binary Search:** Efficient for sorted data, $O(\log n)$ time
- **Interpolation Search:** Best for uniform data, $O(\log \log n)$ average

Sorting Algorithms Summary

- **Simple Sorts ($O(n^2)$):** Bubble, Selection, Insertion - good for small data
- **Advanced Sorts ($O(n \log n)$):** Quick Sort (fast), Merge Sort (stable)
- **Algorithm Choice:** Depends on data size, memory, stability requirements



Summary: Advanced Sorting & Searching II

Key Takeaways

- **Understand your data:** Size, order, distribution affect algorithm choice
- **Know your constraints:** Memory, time, stability requirements matter
- **Practice implementation:** Understanding helps with optimization
- **Benchmark performance:** Theory vs. practice can differ



Outline

- 1 Search Algorithms
- 2 Sorting Algorithms



Thanks!

Questions?



Repo: <https://github.com/EngAndres/ud-public/tree/main/courses/computer-sciences-i>

